

Key Findings

The user interviews strongly validate the core pain points Plasma is designed to solve across different gamer personas. For *Shotcallers* like Shazil, the primary frustrations stem from the logistics of coordinating adult schedules across different time zones and fragmented game launchers, which often results in wasted pre-game time arguing over team roles or waiting for updates. On the other hand, *Completionists* like Khan Burki feel their gaming identity is too scattered across various platforms (Steam, EA, Riot), making it impossible to showcase a unified profile or receive meaningful recognition for difficult achievements. Furthermore, Burki highlighted the social friction of receiving competitive invites while in a casual headspace, underscoring the need for intent-based status signaling. Together, these insights emphasize that gamers are looking for a unified platform to seamlessly coordinate sessions, signal their social availability, and meaningfully share their cross-platform accomplishments.

Interview 1: *The Shotcaller*

Subject: Shazil

Interviewer: Product Researcher

Interviewer: Hey Shazil, thanks for taking the time. To start off, just tell me a bit about your friend group. Do you guys play together often?

Shazil: Uh, yeah. Well, we try to. There's about six or seven of us who have been gaming together since high school. But, uh... it's definitely gotten harder now that we're older. Everyone has different jobs, some moved away. It's not like the old days where you'd just see everyone online after school.

Interviewer: When you say it's gotten harder, what does a typical attempt to get everyone together look like?

Shazil: Oh man, it's a whole thing. I'm usually the one who starts the conversation in the group chat. I'll be like, "Anyone free Friday?" and then... it's just a flood of "maybe" or "what time?" One guy is in Dubai now, so his 8 PM is totally different from ours. I'm literally sitting there with a world clock open trying to figure out if we can even play for two hours before someone has to sleep.

Interviewer: So once you actually nail down a time, is it smooth sailing from there?

Shazil: I wish. Usually, we all jump into Discord, and then we spend the first 30 minutes just... deciding what to play. Someone will say "Let's play Valo," and then someone else realizes they haven't updated it, or they bought the new Call of Duty on a different launcher and half the guys don't even know he has it. It feels like we spend more time talking about playing than actually playing.

Interviewer: Does the software you use now like Steam or Discord; help you see what everyone's up to?

Shazil: Sort of? But it's messy. Steam only shows me Steam stuff. If my buddy is on the Riot launcher or playing something on Epic, he just looks offline to me. I have to literally message him "Yo, you gaming?" which... I don't know, it feels like I'm being annoying. I just want to know if there's a spot for me or if they're already full without having to ask.

Interviewer: What's the most frustrating part once you finally get everyone into the actual game lobby?

Shazil: It's the... uh... the "who does what" part. We'll get five people in a lobby for a raid or a tactical game, and we'll realize we have three people who only want to play the same role. Then we're arguing. If I knew on Wednesday that we were missing a healer, I could've asked someone else to join. Instead, we're just sitting there frustrated. And don't get me started on the people who just... forget to show up. I'm sitting there, game open, just waiting.

Interviewer: Yes, that definitely sounds bad; just because there's not a proper platform to coordinate does not mean you miss out on gaming time. Alright that's it for the interview. Thank you for your time.

Interview 2: *The Completionist*

Subject: Khan Burki (Burki)

Interviewer: Product Researcher

Interviewer: Thanks for joining, Burki. Just to get a feel for your style, what kind of games do you usually gravitate toward?

Burki: Honestly, a bit of everything. I'm a bit of a... I guess you could call it a completionist? Like, if I start a game, I'm not just playing the story. I want to see everything. I want the secret endings, the rare items... all of it.

Interviewer: Do you feel like you get enough "credit" for all that work?

Burki: Not really. I mean, Steam has those achievement things, but they feel kind of... empty? Like, I'll spend ten hours doing a crazy challenge, and it gives me the same little notification as "You Finished Level 1." It doesn't really feel like it counts for much. I wish there was a way to show that... like, the actual effort I put in should be worth more than just a random icon.

Interviewer: You mentioned playing "everything". Do you stick mostly to one platform?

Burki: No, I'm all over the place. I've got stuff on the EA app, Riot, some stuff on Epic because of the free games. It's annoying because my "profile" as a gamer is split up. My Steam friends don't see what I'm doing on other launchers. It's like those hours I put in elsewhere don't exist. I'd love a way to just... have one place where I can show my best moments, no matter where I played them.

Interviewer: How do you usually interact with your friends while you're playing?

Burki: It's hit or miss. Sometimes I'm really into a competitive climb, you know? Like, I'm focused. But other times, I just want to play something casual and listen to music. The problem is my friends don't know which "version" of me they're getting.

Interviewer: Does that cause any issues?

Burki: Yeah, totally. I'll be in the middle of a really chill session, just trying to relax after work, and I'll get these "sweaty" invites for a high-ranked match. I feel bad saying no, but I'm just not in that headspace. I wish there was a way to just... signal what I'm down for. Like, "I'm just chilling tonight, don't send me the hardcore stuff." It would save everyone a lot of awkwardness.

Interviewer: If you could see what your friends were doing throughout the week, would that change how you play?

Burki: Maybe. Right now, the "activity feeds" I see are just... "So-and-so bought a game." I don't care about that. I want to see the cool stuff they actually did. Like, show me their rare trophies or a cool screenshot. If I saw that, I'd actually have something to talk to them about. Right now, it just feels like we're all playing in our own little bubbles.

Interviewer: Thank you for your time. I hope you get that 100% on all the games you've been grinding.